

Generated from the competition table

1986 FIFA World Cup

Everything the FIFA World Cup edition table records about 1986, with each placing linked to that team's full history.

Host(s)

Mexico

Teams

24

Winner

Argentina

Runner-up

West Germany

Third

France

Fourth / other semifinalist

Belgium

Final

**Argentina 3-2 West
Germany**

Final date

29 June 1986

Top scorer

**Gary Lineker
(England, 6 goals)**

The story of this edition

Diego Maradona inspired Argentina in 1986.

[All FIFA World Cup editions →](#)



References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed: 31 August 2026

- FIFA tournament history and champions (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/world-cup-champions-1930-1978-uruguay-italy-germany-brazil-england-argentina>),
- FIFA tournament history and champions (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/world-cup-champions-1982-2026-italy-argentina-germany-brazil-france-spain>),
- FIFA 2026 awards (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/award-winners>)
- FIFA historical top scorers (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/fontaine-mbappe-ronaldo-and-more-every-world-cup-top-scorer>)
- Golden Ball (best player) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/rodri-earns-adidas-golden-ball>)
- Golden Ball (best player) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (https://www.espn.com/soccer/story/_/id/49404995/2026-world-cup-golden-ball-spain-unai-simon-pau-cubarsi)
- Golden Ball (best player) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (<https://www.beinsports.com/en-us/soccer/fifa-world-cup-2026/articles/why-did-the-world-cup-golden-ball-end-up-in-rodri-s-hands-2026-07-22>)
- Golden Ball (best player) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (<https://www.olympics.com/en/news/fifa-world-cup-2026-messi-mbappe-bellingham-rodri-golden-ball-football>)
- Golden Ball (best player) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (<https://www.foxsports.com/stories/soccer/2026-fifa-mens-world-cup-every-world-cup-golden-ball-winner-since-1982>),
- Golden Ball (best player) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (<https://blog.wego.com/world-cup-golden-ball-winners/>),
- Golden Ball (best player) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (<https://www.si.com/soccer/world-cup-golden-ball-full-list-winners>),
- Golden Ball (best player) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (<https://www.topendsports.com/events/worldcupsoccer/golden-ball.htm>),
- Silver Ball and Bronze Ball (Golden Ball runners-up) winners (added (https://fbref.com/en/awards/wc_silver_ball/FIFA-World-Cup-Silver-Ball))
- Silver Ball and Bronze Ball (Golden Ball runners-up) winners (added (<https://blog.wego.com/world-cup-golden-ball-winners/>),
- Silver Ball and Bronze Ball (Golden Ball runners-up) winners (added (<https://www.rsssf.org/miscellaneous/fifa-gb86.html>),
- Silver Ball and Bronze Ball (Golden Ball runners-up) winners (added (<https://www.rsssf.org/miscellaneous/fifa-gb90.html>),
- Silver Ball and Bronze Ball (Golden Ball runners-up) winners (added (<https://www.fifa.com/en/news/articles/salvatore-schillaci-tribute-italy>),

- Silver Ball and Bronze Ball (Golden Ball runners-up) winners (added (<https://www.plus.fifa.com/en/content/davor-suker-silver-ball-award-1998-fifa-world-cup-france/838db664-5cec-40cd-9a3d-0bda1b858a49>).
- Silver Ball and Bronze Ball (Golden Ball runners-up) winners (added (<https://www.plus.fifa.com/en/content/lilian-thuram-bronze-ball-award-1998-fifa-world-cup-france/552e8ebd-16b7-487b-a861-b1ee4e43f6ab>).
- Silver Ball and Bronze Ball (Golden Ball runners-up) winners (added (https://www.thesoccerworldcups.com/world_cups/2010_awards.php).
- Silver Ball and Bronze Ball (Golden Ball runners-up) winners (added (https://www.espn.com/soccer/story/_/id/49404995/2026-world-cup-golden-ball-spain-unai-simon-pau-cubarsi).
- Silver Ball and Bronze Ball (Golden Ball runners-up) winners (added (<https://sports.yahoo.com/articles/every-award-winner-2026-world-233500005.html>).
- Golden Glove (best goalkeeper) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/unai-simon-adidas-golden-glove>).
- Golden Glove (best goalkeeper) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a (https://www.espn.com/soccer/story/_/id/49024760/2026-world-cup-awards-golden-ball-golden-boot-golden-glove-trophies-revealed).
- Golden Glove (best goalkeeper) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a (<https://www.si.com/soccer/every-world-cup-golden-glove-winner>).
- Golden Glove (best goalkeeper) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a (<https://www.goal.com/en/news/list-of-fifa-world-cup-golden-glove-winners/blt81d4e6d207efc5ff>).
- Golden Glove (best goalkeeper) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a (<https://www.nzherald.co.nz/sport/football/football-world-cup/soccer-germanys-kahn-named-best-goalkeeper-at-cup/TK3UHH6DI4DUUQFZEXZRTYUKR4/>).
- Golden Glove (best goalkeeper) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a (<https://www.plus.fifa.com/en/content/oliver-kahn-lev-yashin-award-2002-fifa-world-cup-korea-japan/235d069a-542f-4d26-8b91-f3ab2dc42649>).
- Golden Glove (best goalkeeper) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a (<https://www.goal.com/en/news/world-cup-2010-spains-iker-casillas-wins-golden-glove-ahead/bltf926cf07eb87996a>).
- Young Player Award (best player aged 21 or under) winners (added (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/young-player-award-winners-highlights>).
- Young Player Award (best player aged 21 or under) winners (added (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/pau-cubarsi-fifa-young-player-award>).

- Young Player Award (best player aged 21 or under) winners (added (<https://www.foxsports.com/stories/soccer/world-cup-pau-cubarsi-spain-young-player-award>).
- Young Player Award (best player aged 21 or under) winners (added (<https://sports.yahoo.com/articles/barcelona-star-pau-cubarsi-wins-000000915.html>).
- Young Player Award (best player aged 21 or under) winners (added (<https://sports.yahoo.com/articles/young-player-award-winners-fifa-121400761.html>).
- Young Player Award (best player aged 21 or under) winners (added (https://www.espn.com/soccer/story/_/id/48760910/who-won-young-player-award-world-cup).
- Young Player Award (best player aged 21 or under) winners (added (<https://khelnow.com/football/fifa-world-cup-list-of-best-young-player-award-winners>).
- Young Player Award (best player aged 21 or under) winners (added (<https://www.topendsports.com/events/worldcupsoccer/best-young-player.htm>).
- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (<https://worldsoccertalk.com/world-cup/list-of-world-cup-winning-coaches-every-manager-to-win-the-trophy-by-year/>).
- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (<https://www.myfootballfacts.com/world-football/fifa/world-cup/fifa-all-time-world-cup/fifa-world-cup-winning-managers/>).
- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (<https://www.beinsports.com/en-us/soccer/fifa-world-cup-2026/articles/all-fifa-world-cup-winning-coaches-in-history-complete-list-and-finals-2026-05-06>).
- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Juan_L%C3%B3pez_Fontana).
- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Aymor%C3%A9_Moreira).
- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (<https://www.tbsnews.net/sports/unbroken-pact-how-every-world-cup-champion-has-been-led-one-their-own-1461436>).
- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (<https://www.90min.com/posts/the-most-successful-world-cup-managers-ever>).
- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (<https://www.aninews.in/news/sports/football/fifa-world-cup-2026-spains-luis-de-la-fuente-becomes-oldest-coach-to-win-global-tournament20260720035714/>).

- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicou2026/articles/luis-de-la-fuente-method-coaching>)
- Winning managers (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Winning managers" (https://www.espn.com/soccer/story/_/id/49406168/luis-de-la-fuentes-team-ethos-won-world-cup-spain)
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-02): the calendar date of each edition's (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1930_FIFA_World_Cup_final)
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-02): the calendar date of each edition's (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1966_FIFA_World_Cup_final)
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-02): the calendar date of each edition's (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2022_FIFA_World_Cup_final)
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-02): the calendar date of each edition's (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2026_FIFA_World_Cup_final)
- Final match dates second independent cross-check (2026-08-09, intensive (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1934_FIFA_World_Cup_final)
- Final match dates second independent cross-check (2026-08-09, intensive (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1994_FIFA_World_Cup_final)
- Final match dates second independent cross-check (2026-08-09, intensive (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicou2026/final>)
- Third/fourth-place audit (2026-08-04): the winner and loser of every (<https://www.espn.com/soccer/>)
- Third/fourth-place audit (2026-08-04): the winner and loser of every (<https://plus.fifa.com/>)
- Third/fourth-place audit (2026-08-04): the winner and loser of every (<https://www.athlet.org/>)
- **One discrepancy found and fixed:** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicou2026/articles/spain-argentina-final-report-highlights>)
- **One discrepancy found and fixed:** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/760517/argentina-spain)
- **One discrepancy found and fixed:** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (<https://www.cbsnews.com/news/2026-fifa-world-cup-final-spain-argentina-sunday/>)
- **One discrepancy found and fixed:** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicou2026/articles/france-england-report-highlights-bronze-final>)
- **One discrepancy found and fixed:** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/760516/england-france)

- ****One discrepancy found and fixed:**** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (<https://www.foxnews.com/sports/england-wins-thriller-ages-france-claim-third-2026-fifa-world-cup>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score audit (2026-08-05, intensive run): the core (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/world-cup-champions-1930-1978-uruguay-italy-germany-brazil-england-argentina>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score audit (2026-08-05, intensive run): the core (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/world-cup-champions-1982-2026-italy-argentina-germany-brazil-france-spain>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score audit (2026-08-05, intensive run): the core (<https://www.espn.com/soccer/>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score audit (2026-08-05, intensive run): the core (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1934_FIFA_World_Cup_final).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score audit (2026-08-05, intensive run): the core (<https://www.bbc.com/sport/football>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score audit (2026-08-05, intensive run): the core (<https://www.cnn.com/sport/football>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.rsssf.org/tables/30f.html>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.britannica.com/event/World-Cup-2010>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.worldfootball.net/report/wm-1970-in-mexiko-ends-piel-brasilien-italien/>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (https://www.transfermarkt.us/germany_argentina/index/spielbericht/2466308).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.11v11.com/matches/brazil-v-italy-17-july-1994-245173/>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.skysports.com/football/news/12098/11437927>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.thefa.com/news/2014/jul/29/england-west-germany-world-cup-final-1966-4-2>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.cbssports.com/soccer/news/>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.espn.com/soccer/>).
- Host(s)/Teams audit (2026-08-08, intensive run): the first-ever (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/FIFA_World_Cup).
- Host(s)/Teams audit (2026-08-08, intensive run): the first-ever (<https://www.rsssf.org/>).
- Host(s)/Teams audit (2026-08-08, intensive run): the first-ever (<https://www.footballhistory.org/>).

- Host(s)/Teams audit (2026-08-08, intensive run): the first-ever (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.worldfootball.net/competition/co139/fifa-world-cup/se2413/1966-england/all-matches/>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.worldfootball.net/competition/co139/fifa-world-cup/se2414/1970-mexico/teams/>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.worldfootball.net/competition/co139/fifa-world-cup/se2418/1986-mexico/teams/>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.britannica.com/today-in-history/july-13-1930-First-FIFA-World-Cup>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.britannica.com/event/2026-FIFA-World-Cup>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (https://liquipedia.net/lab/Football/FIFA/World_Cup/1958).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (https://liquipedia.net/lab/Football/FIFA/World_Cup/1974).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.transfermarkt.us/mundial-de-qatar-2022/teilnehmer/pokalwettbewerb/wm22/sort/teilnahmen>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (https://grokipedia.com/page/1938_FIFA_World_Cup).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/number-teams-every-edition>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://sports.yahoo.com/articles/why-2026-world-cup-spread-133500991.html>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.mlssoccer.com/news/fifa-world-cup-2026-format-explained>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.skysports.com/football/news/11095/13272067/2026-world-cup-dates-venues-host-cities-format-and-schedule-for-usa-canada-and-mexico-tournament>).
- Third/fourth-place second independent cross-check (2026-08-11, intensive (<https://www.nbcbayarea.com/world-cup/every-third-place-game-result-in-fifa-world-cup-history/3102549/>).
- Third/fourth-place second independent cross-check (2026-08-11, intensive (<https://sports.yahoo.com/every-third-place-game-result-110022284.html>).

- Third/fourth-place second independent cross-check (2026-08-11, intensive (<https://www.soccergraph.com/2026/07/fifa-world-cup-third-place-playoff-winners-bronze-mdalists-history.html>).
- Third/fourth-place second independent cross-check (2026-08-11, intensive (<https://www.rsssf.org/tables/30full.html>).
- Third/fourth-place second independent cross-check (2026-08-11, intensive (https://www.sport-histoire.fr/en/Sport/Football/World_Cup/1950_World_Cup.php).
- Third/fourth-place second independent cross-check (2026-08-11, intensive (<https://www.aljazeera.com/sports/liveblog/2026/7/18/france-vs-england-live-fifa-world-cup-2026-third-place-playoff>).

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.